Amblygonite

△ **Transparent, coloured** amblygonite rough

The Greek words *amblus* (“blunt”) and *gouia* (“angle”), are the origin of amblygonite’s name – an allusion to the shape of its crystals. Most amblygonite is found as large, white, translucent masses, and it is often used as a rich source of lithium. Gem-quality amblygonite is less common and tends to be transparent, with a yellow, greenish-yellow, or lilac colour. Although it can be faceted and used as a gemstone, it is vulnerable to breakage and abrasion from general wear when set into jewellery, and so is cut principally for collectors.

Specification

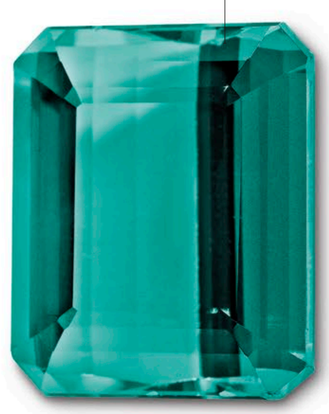
Chemical name Lithium, sodium alumino-phosphate
Formula $(Li,Na)AlPO_4(F,OH)$ | **Colours** White, yellow, lilac
Structure Triclinic | **Hardness** 5.5–6 | **SG** 3.0–3.1
RI 1.57–1.64 | **Lustre** Vitreous to greasy or pearly
Streak White | **Locations** France, Brazil; California, USA

Amblygonite rough | **Rough** | The transparency of this piece of amblygonite rough is obscured by the reflections from its uneven surface.

Amblygonite with wavellite | **Rough** | In this example, the raw amblygonite has coated another phosphate mineral, wavellite, with a translucent layer.

Brilliant oval | **Cut** | The clarity and flawlessness of this colourless amblygonite is brought out by a simple yet effective, oval brilliant cut.

The **largest documented** single crystal of **amblygonite** measured **15m³** (530ft³)



Emerald cut | **Cut** | The use of a classic emerald step cut emphasizes the extremely rare blue-green colouring of this amblygonite stone.

Yellow-green transparent | **Colour variety** | The cutter of this oval amblygonite has added a number of extra facets to the brilliant cut, to maximize the play of light and so bring out the stone’s subtle colouring.